

Four children can take sides in 25 ways, and 6 of those are one against one

Every possible split into two opposing sides, with anyone left over staying out of it.

These are possibilities, not arguments that happened — and the commonest case of all, nobody taking sides, is not among them.

 one side  the other side  staying out
A vs B and B vs A are the same split, and are counted once.

One against one — the sibling pairs (6 of 25)



A vs B

C+D stays out



A vs C

B+D stays out



A vs D

B+C stays out



B vs C

A+D stays out



B vs D

A+C stays out



C vs D

A+B stays out

One against two (12)



A vs B+C

D stays out



A vs B+D

C stays out



A vs C+D

B stays out



B vs A+C

D stays out



B vs A+D

C stays out



B vs C+D

A stays out



C vs A+B

D stays out



C vs A+D

B stays out



C vs B+D

A stays out



D vs A+B

C stays out



D vs A+C

B stays out



D vs B+C

A stays out

One against three (4)



A vs B+C+D

nobody left out



B vs A+C+D

nobody left out



C vs A+B+D

nobody left out



D vs A+B+C

nobody left out

Two against two (3)



A+B vs C+D

nobody left out



A+C vs B+D

nobody left out



A+D vs B+C

nobody left out